



[Weekly Market Commentary](#)

Dear clients,

This week, the US Consumer Price Index (CPI) for February came in lower than expected, temporarily prompting a recovery in many beaten up stocks and crypto assets. However, the optimism didn't last as concerns over economic activity continue to overwhelm other market drivers. Plus, there are plenty of additional macro events to watch in the days and weeks ahead. That includes the US government's funding resolution to avoid a shutdown (deadline: March 15 at 12:01am ET), the Fed's upcoming FOMC meeting (March 18-19) and 1Q25 earnings reports in April.

Meanwhile, the Senate Banking Committee marked up and voted on a bipartisan stablecoin bill (the GENIUS Act) this week, bringing this closer to a floor vote sometime in 2025. The latest update allows state authorities to regulate stablecoin issuers with market caps under US\$10B, while larger issuers may fall under the Federal Reserve's oversight. Separately, President Trump's executive order from January is expected to result in a crypto market structure bill sometime in the coming months.

Finally, decentralized exchange (DEX) volumes across multiple chains have dropped more than 60% from their late January highs, according to DeFiLlama. Memecoin trading activity has been hit particularly hard, reflected in Solana's 82% drop in DEX volumes since the US presidential inauguration in January. Despite that, the Solana community has been extremely active lately. In particular, SOL's economics have come into the spotlight with the finalization of its SIMD-228 vote (which was ultimately defeated) on reducing SOL inflation.

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